WANDERSTAY · FIND YOUR PERFECT STAY

UX research

What travellers need when they book a hotel in Thailand on their phone, and how it shaped the app

Sample findings for the case study. Replace them with your own study data.

PROBLEM

Travellers booking a stay in Thailand on mobile spend too long comparing options, and still worry about hidden fees, misleading photos and what happens after they pay.

RESEARCH GOALS

- Understand how people search, shortlist and decide on a stay
- Find what builds or breaks trust before paying
- Map pains after booking, from check-in to the review

RESEARCH QUESTIONS

- What makes a traveller confident enough to book?
- Which filters and details matter most when comparing?
- Where do people drop out of the booking flow, and why?
- What do they need from the app once the trip starts?

Methods

User interviews

8 × 45 min remote interviews with people who booked a stay in Thailand in the last 6 months

Planned: 8 participants

Online survey

Screener and survey on booking habits, devices, payment and what builds trust

Planned: 60+ responses

Competitive usability review

Task walkthroughs of 4 existing booking apps: search, compare, pay, manage a booking

4 apps · 5 tasks each

Card sorting

Open card sort of 30 hotel attributes to shape filters, room cards and the detail page

Planned: 12 participants

Key insights

1 Price surprises break trust

Participants abandon when taxes and fees appear only at the last step.

"It said ฿3,000, then it was ฿3,600 at checkout. I closed the app."

→ Designed in: 21 Checkout · 13 Hotel detail

2 Photos decide, reviews confirm

People shortlist from photos first, then read recent reviews to check the photos are real.

"I scroll the pictures, then I look for reviews with photos from guests."

→ Designed in: 14 Gallery · 15 Reviews

3 Free cancellation lowers the stakes

A flexible policy makes people book earlier instead of waiting and comparing for days.

"If I can cancel for free, I just book it now and keep looking."

→ Designed in: 17 Select room · 18 Room detail

4 Too many results, too few filters

Long lists feel overwhelming; people want a few filters that match how they think (area, pool, breakfast).

"I don't need 400 hotels. I need the 5 that fit."

→ Designed in: 08 Search · 09 Filter · 10 Map

5 Local payment matters

Thai users expect PromptPay and saved cards; entering card details on mobile feels risky.

"I always pay with PromptPay, it's faster and I trust it more."

→ Designed in: 22 Payment method · 23 Add card

6 The trip doesn't end at payment

After booking, people dig through email for the voucher and want a quick way to contact the hotel.

"I had to search my inbox at reception to find the booking number."

→ Designed in: 25 Booking voucher · 26 Chat

HOW MIGHT WE

- How might we show the full price from the first card, so the checkout total never surprises?
- How might we help travellers trust photos and reviews within seconds?
- How might we turn hundreds of results into a confident shortlist of five?
- How might we keep everything for the trip in one place after paying?

DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Principle	Description
Honest pricing	Total incl. taxes on every card and in one breakdown
Show, then prove	Big photos first, guest reviews one tap away
Fewer, smarter choices	Filters that match how people think about a stay
With you after booking	Voucher, QR check-in and hotel chat in the app

WANDERSTAY · FIND YOUR PERFECT STAY

Personas

Three traveller types drawn from the research: one primary, two secondary

Proto-personas based on sample findings. Validate them with real interviews.

MN Martin Novak PRIMARY

32 · Remote product designer · Prague, travels to Thailand twice a year

"I want to see the real total and real photos, then book in a few taps."

Works from anywhere and mixes work trips with beach time. Plans a week ahead, books on his phone between meetings and cares about a good desk and Wi-Fi.

GOALS

- Find a stay that fits his budget and work needs fast
- Know the full price before he commits
- Keep the voucher and hotel contact in one place

FRUSTRATIONS

- Taxes and fees that appear only at checkout
- Photos that don't match the room
- Hunting for the booking email at reception

BEHAVIOUR

Trait	Level
Price sensitivity	Medium
Plans ahead	Medium
Tech comfort	High

iPhone · Books solo or as a couple · Card payment · Reads recent reviews

WHAT WANDERSTAY GIVES MARTIN

- ✓ Tax-inclusive prices on every card
- ✓ Gallery and reviews with guest photos
- ✓ In-app voucher with QR and hotel chat

PS Ploy Srisuk SECONDARY

28 · Marketing executive · Bangkok

"If I can cancel for free and pay with PromptPay, I'll book it tonight."

Plans weekend getaways with friends to Hua Hin or Koh Samui, often a few days before. Compares deals quickly and shares options in the group chat.

GOALS

- Find a good deal for this weekend
- Share a shortlist with friends
- Pay the way she always does

FRUSTRATIONS

- Endless lists with no way to narrow down
- Typing card numbers on her phone
- Strict cancellation rules for last-minute plans

BEHAVIOUR

Trait	Level
Price sensitivity	High
Plans ahead	Low
Tech comfort	High

Android · Groups of 3–4 friends · PromptPay · Deal hunter

WHAT WANDERSTAY GIVES PLOY

- ✓ Weekly deals and smart filters
- ✓ Free-cancellation badges on room cards
- ✓ PromptPay and saved payment methods

DK Daniel Kim SECONDARY

41 · Engineer and father of two · Singapore

"With two kids, I need to know exactly what the room has before we go."

Books one or two family holidays a year months in advance. Reads every detail about beds, pool and breakfast, and wants help on the day of travel.

GOALS

- Be sure the room fits the whole family
- Get airport pickup and check-in sorted early
- Avoid surprises on arrival

FRUSTRATIONS

- Unclear bed setup and guest limits
- No easy way to ask the hotel a question
- Long check-in queues with tired kids

BEHAVIOUR

Trait	Level
Price sensitivity	Medium
Plans ahead	High
Tech comfort	Medium

iPad and phone · Family of 4 · Credit card · Detail checker

WHAT WANDERSTAY GIVES DANIEL

- ✓ Room details: beds, size and guest count
- ✓ Guests and rooms selector with children
- ✓ Chat with hotel and QR express check-in

WANDERSTAY · UX RESEARCH

Customer journey map

Booking a 3-night stay in Thailand, from first idea to the next trip

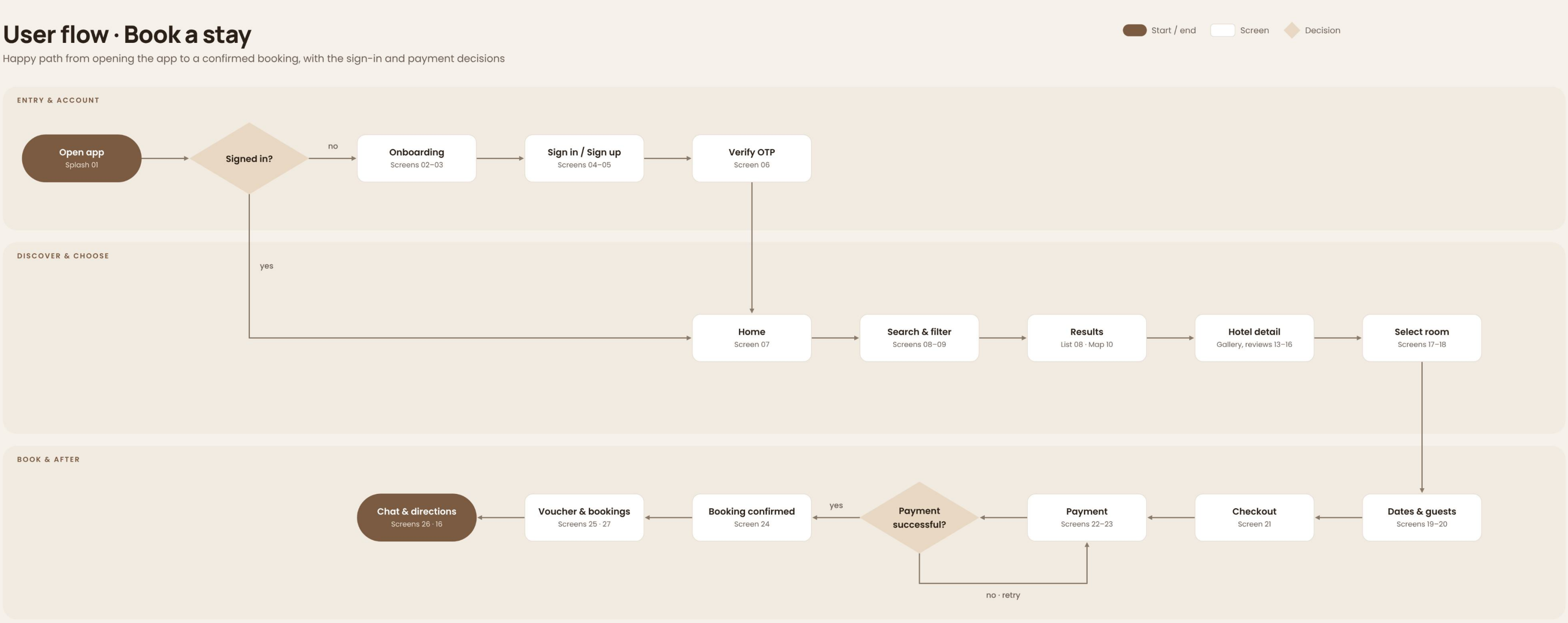
MN Persona · Martin, 32, remote designer

Takes 2–3 leisure trips a year, plans and books on his phone. Cares about real photos, transparent prices and free cancellation.

	1 Inspire	2 Search	3 Compare	4 Book & pay	5 Pre-stay	6 Stay	7 Post-stay
Goals	Find inspiration for a getaway	Find stays that fit dates and budget	Choose the right hotel and room	Book quickly and securely	Feel prepared for the trip	Smooth check-in and a great stay	Share the experience, book again
Actions & touchpoints	Opens app, browses Splash, Home picks and weekly deals in Explore	Searches a destination, applies filters, switches to map view	Opens hotel detail, gallery, reviews and the room list	Selects dates and guests, checks out, pays by card or PromptPay	Gets confirmation, opens voucher, chats with the hotel	Shows QR at check-in, uses directions and in-stay chat	Leaves a review, earns points, saves the hotel
Thoughts	*"Where should I go this January?"*	*"There are so many options…"*	*"Are the photos real? Is it worth it?"*	*"I hope there are no hidden fees."*	*"Great, the airport pickup is sorted."*	*"Check-in took two minutes!"*	*"I'll save this place for next time."*
Emotions	Excited	Curious	Unsure	Anxious	Reassured	Delighted	Loyal
Pain points	Suggestions don't match budget or travel dates	Too many results; prices shown without taxes	Hard to compare rooms; cancellation rules unclear	Long forms, surprise fees, failed payments	Confirmation buried in email	Queues at reception, staff hard to reach	Review requests feel like spam
Opportunities	Personalised picks and deals on Home and Explore	Smart filters, tax-inclusive prices, price pins on the map	Review summary, room cards with policy badges	Full price breakdown, saved cards, 3-step checkout	In-app voucher with QR, reminders, hotel chat	QR express check-in, requests through chat	One-tap review with points, rebook from Favorites

User flow · Book a stay

Happy path from opening the app to a confirmed booking, with the sign-in and payment decisions

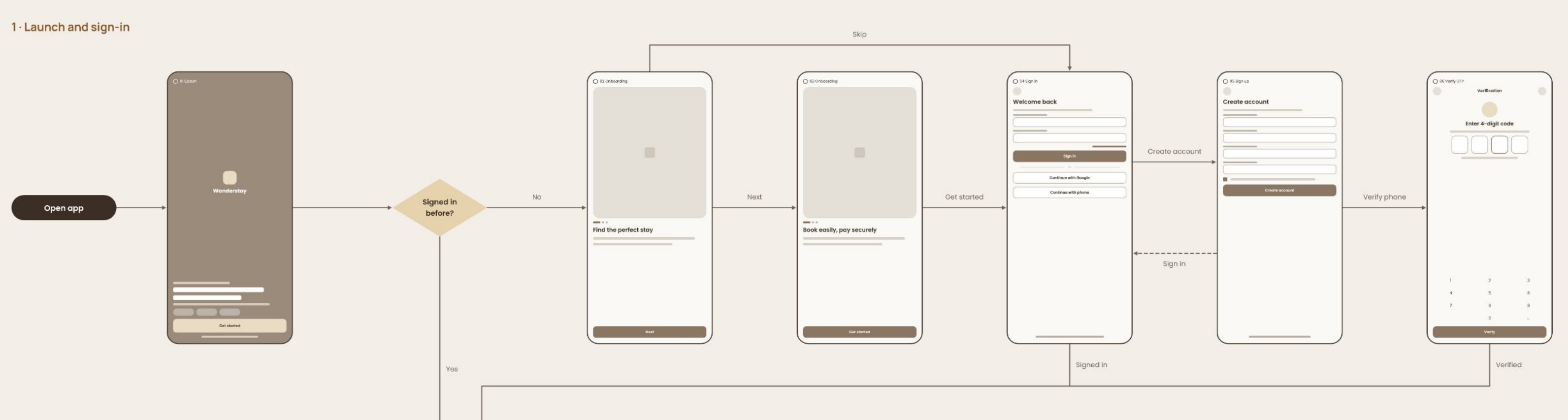


Wireframes

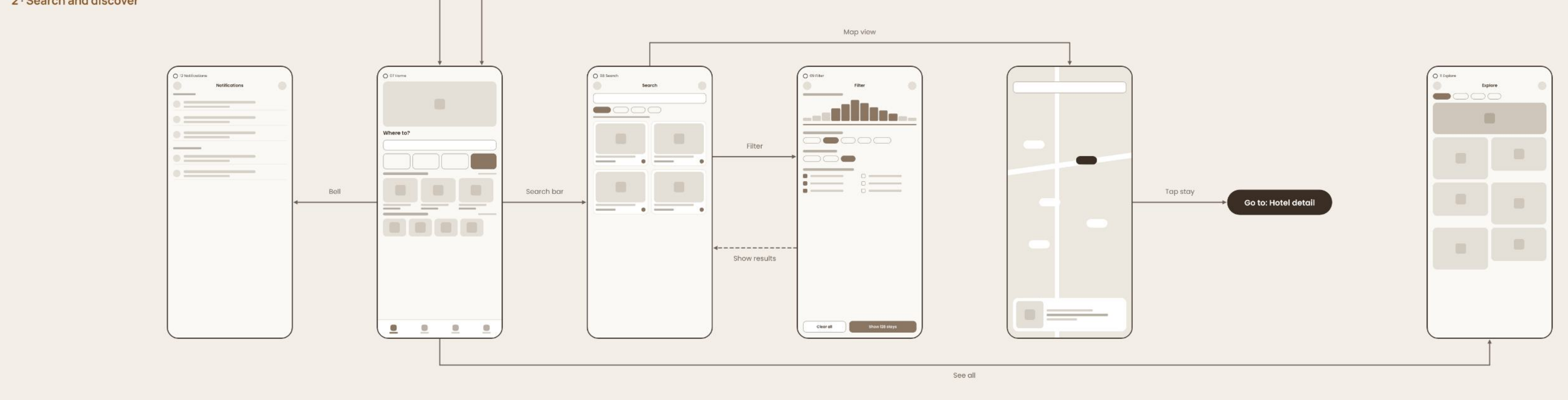
Low-fi wireframes for Wanderstay: the same 30 screens and numbering as the UI design, grouped into 5 flows. Each arrow shows what a tap opens; dashed arrows go back.

Start / go to · Screen · Decision · Tap / next · Back / close

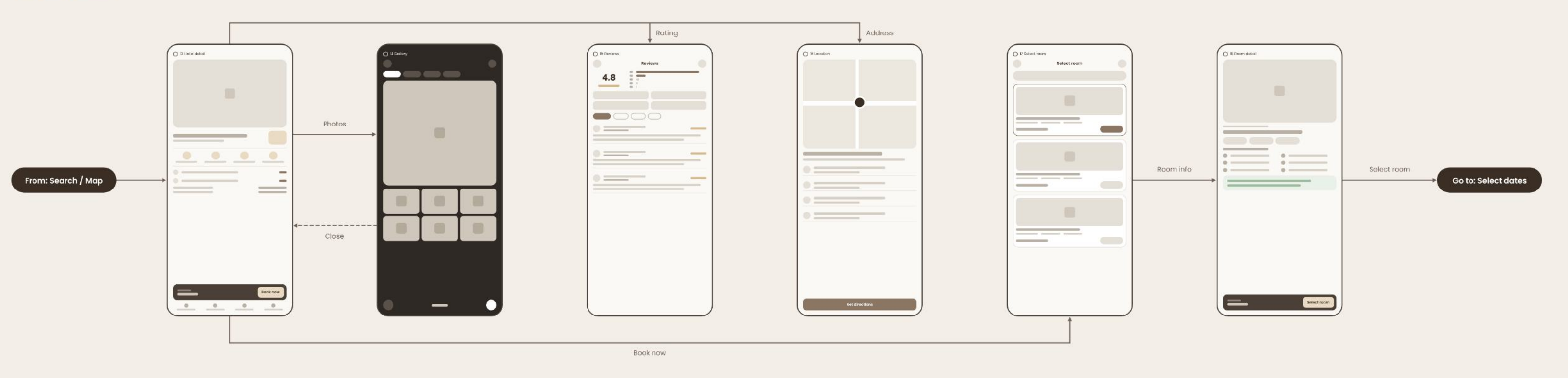
1 · Launch and sign-in



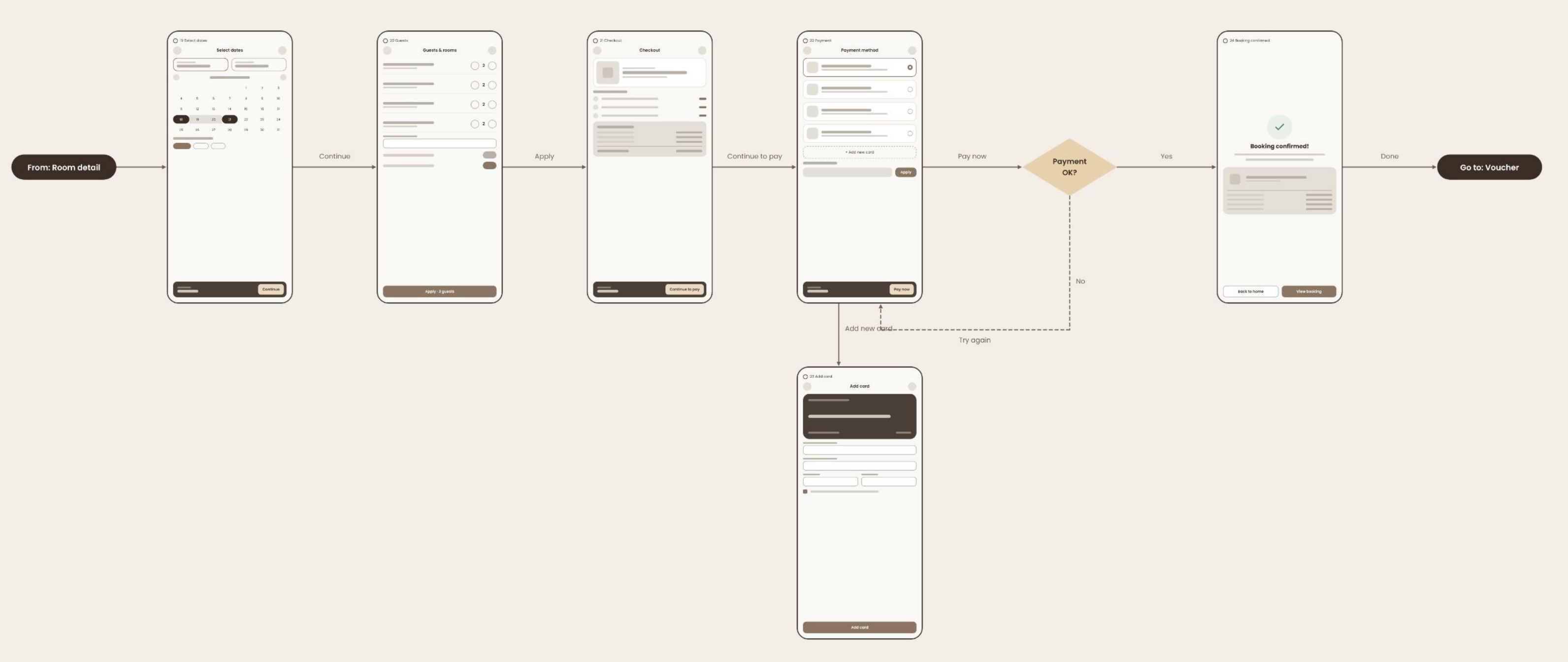
2 · Search and discover



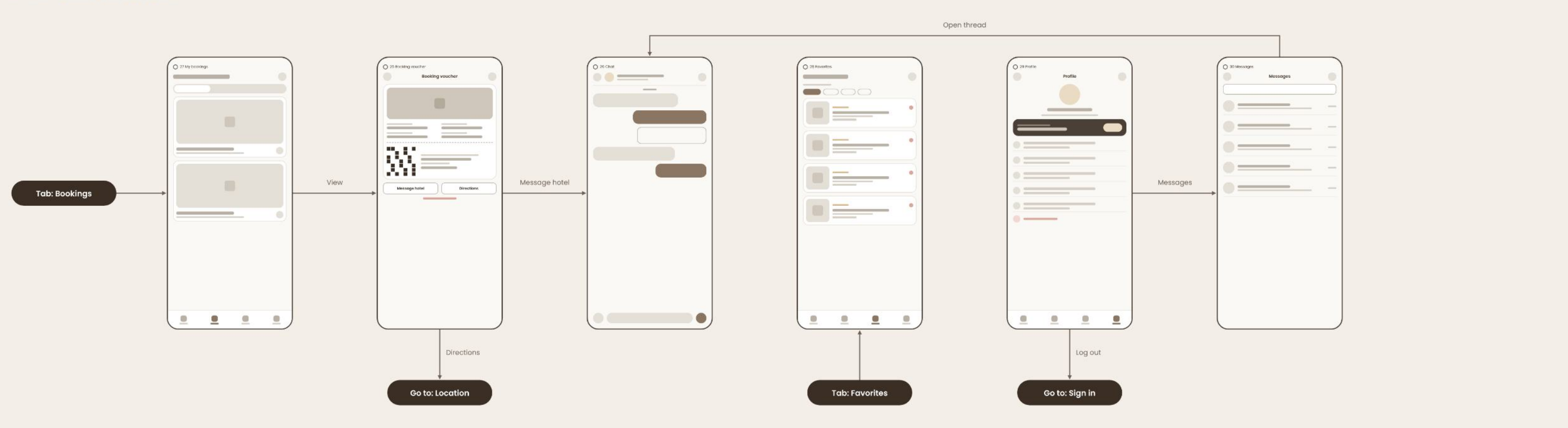
3 · Property details



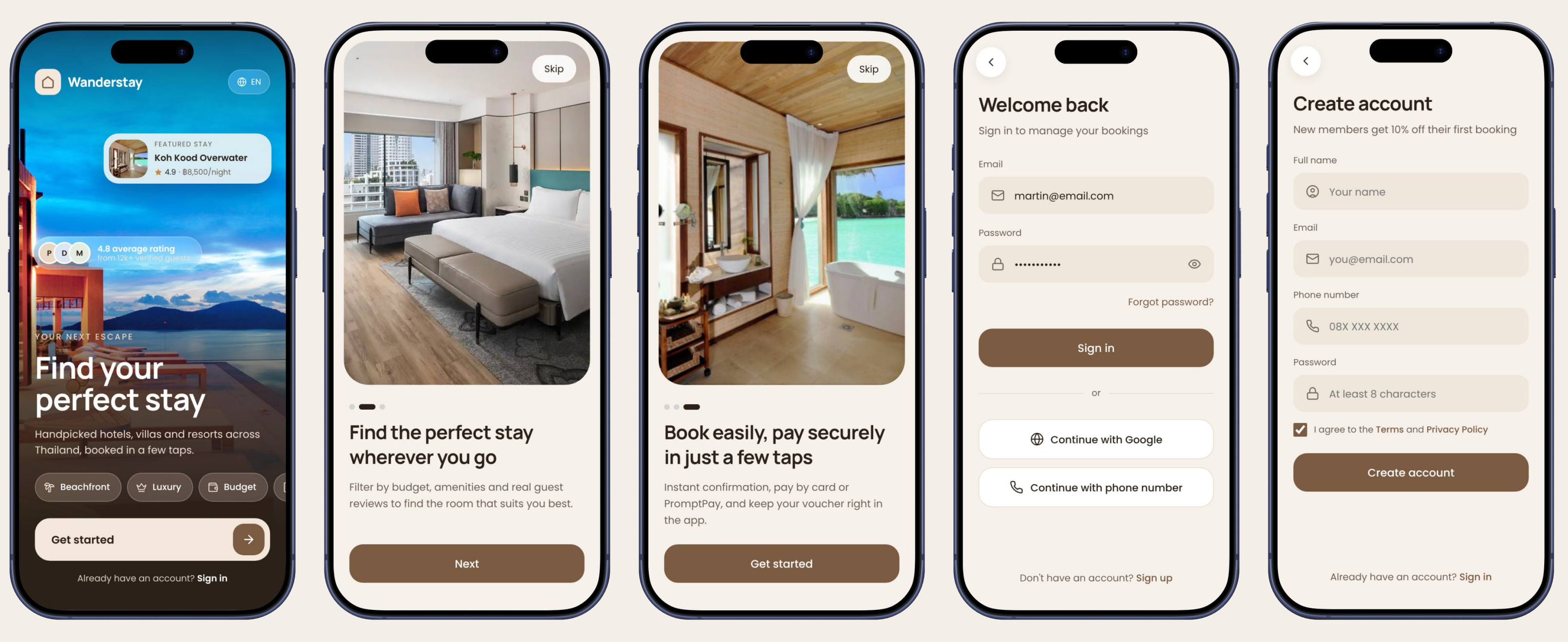
4 · Booking and payment



5 · After booking and account



The bottom tab bar (Home, Bookings, Favorites, Profile) opens those screens from any screen that shows it. "Go to" pills jump to a screen drawn elsewhere on this board.



Find your perfect stay

Handpicked hotels, villas and resorts across Thailand, booked in a few taps.

Already have an account? Sign in

Find the perfect stay wherever you go

Filter by budget, amenities and real guest reviews to find the room that suits you best.

Book easily, pay securely in just a few taps

Instant confirmation, pay by card or PromptPay, and keep your voucher right in the app.

Welcome back

Sign in to manage your bookings

Email: martin@email.com

Password: ••••••••••

Forgot password?

Don't have an account? Sign up

Create account

New members get 10% off their first booking

Full name: Your name

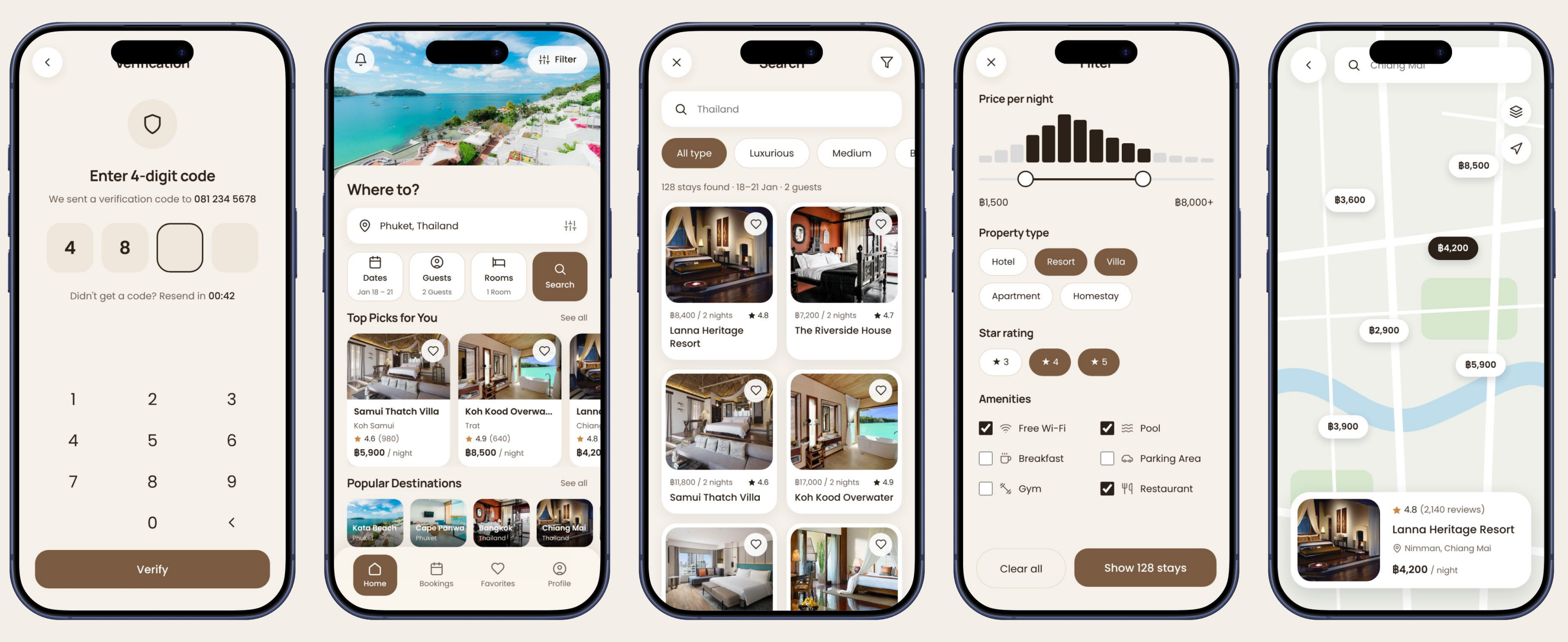
Email: you@email.com

Phone number: 08X XXX XXXX

Password: At least 8 characters

☑ I agree to the Terms and Privacy Policy

Already have an account? Sign in



Enter 4-digit code

We sent a verification code to 081 234 5678

4 8

Didn't get a code? Resend in 00:42

Phuket, Thailand

Dates: Jan 18 – 21 · Guests: 2 Guests · Rooms: 1 Room

Samui Thatch Villa · Koh Samui · ★ 4.6 (980) · ฿5,900 / night

Koh Kood Overwa… · Trat · ★ 4.9 (640) · ฿8,500 / night

Thailand

128 stays found · 18–21 Jan · 2 guests

฿8,400 / 2 nights ★ 4.8 Lanna Heritage Resort

฿7,200 / 2 nights ★ 4.7 The Riverside House

฿11,800 / 2 nights ★ 4.6 Samui Thatch Villa

฿17,000 / 2 nights ★ 4.9 Koh Kood Overwater

Amenities

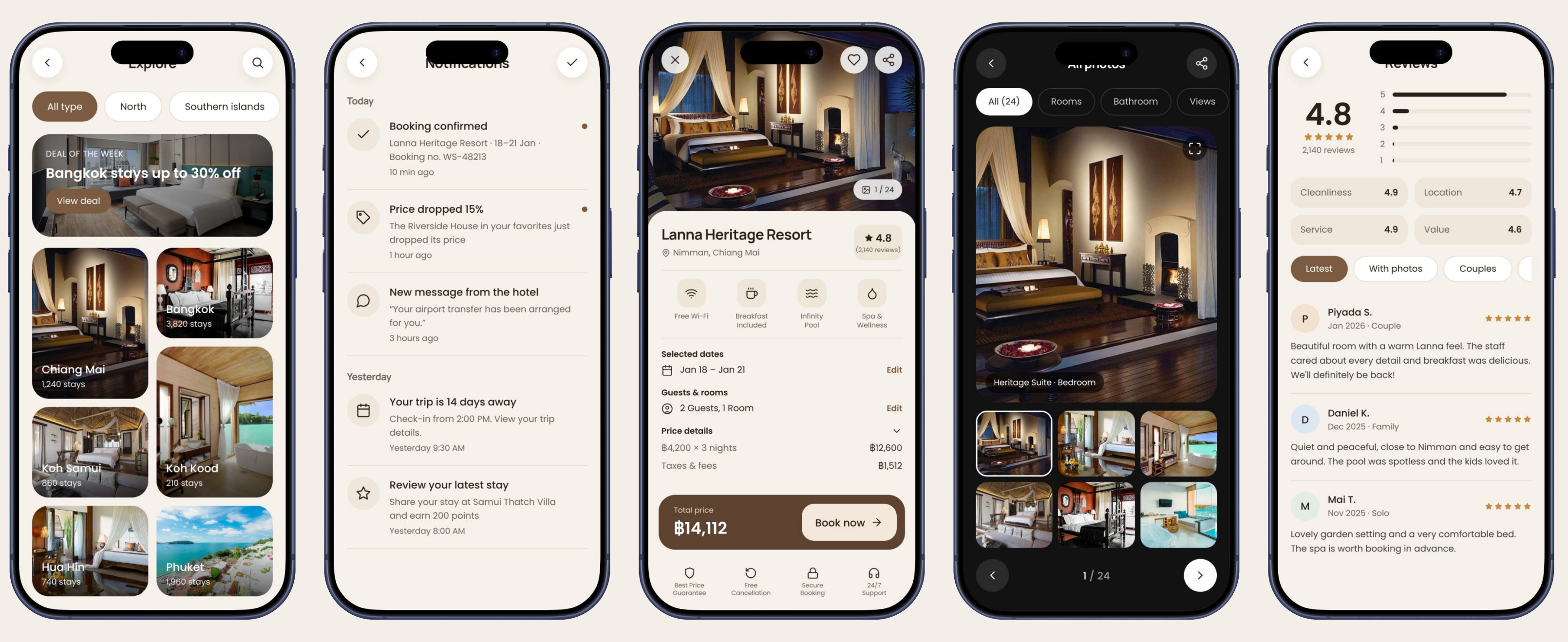
☑ Free Wi-Fi ☑ Pool

☐ Breakfast ☐ Parking Area

☐ Gym ☑ Restaurant

Chiang Mai

★ 4.8 (2,140 reviews) Lanna Heritage Resort · Nimman, Chiang Mai · ฿4,200 / night



DEAL OF THE WEEK

Bangkok stays up to 30% off

Chiang Mai 1,240 stays · Bangkok 3,820 stays · Koh Samui 860 stays · Koh Kood 210 stays · Hua Hin 740 stays · Phuket 1,960 stays

Today

Booking confirmed — Lanna Heritage Resort · 18–21 Jan · Booking no. WS-48213 — 10 min ago

Price dropped 15% — The Riverside House in your favorites just dropped its price — 1 hour ago

New message from the hotel — "Your airport transfer has been arranged for you." — 3 hours ago

Yesterday

Your trip is 14 days away — Check-in from 2:00 PM. View your trip details. — Yesterday 9:30 AM

Review your latest stay — Share your stay at Samui Thatch Villa and earn 200 points — Yesterday 8:00 AM

Lanna Heritage Resort ★ 4.8 (2,140 reviews)

Nimman, Chiang Mai

Selected dates: Jan 18 – Jan 21 · Edit

Guests & rooms: 2 Guests, 1 Room · Edit

Price details

฿4,200 × 3 nights	฿12,600
Taxes & fees	฿1,512

Total price ฿14,112

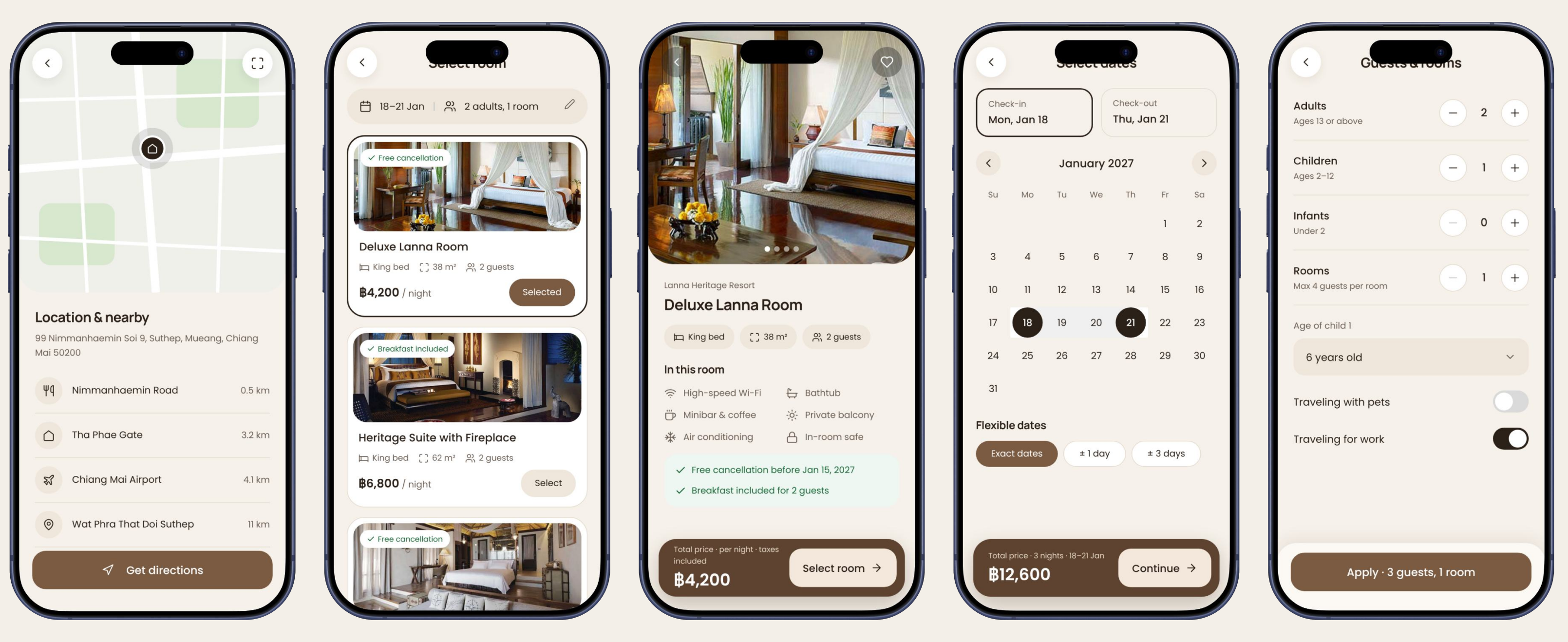
4.8 ★★★★★ 2,140 reviews

Cleanliness	4.9	Location	4.7
Service	4.9	Value	4.6

Piyada S. · Jan 2026 · Couple ★★★★★
Beautiful room with a warm Lanna feel. The staff cared about every detail and breakfast was delicious. We'll definitely be back!

Daniel K. · Dec 2025 · Family ★★★★★
Quiet and peaceful, close to Nimman and easy to get around. The pool was spotless and the kids loved it.

Mai T. · Nov 2025 · Solo ★★★★★
Lovely garden setting and a very comfortable bed. The spa is worth booking in advance.



Location & nearby

99 Nimmanhaemin Soi 9, Suthep, Mueang, Chiang Mai 50200

Nimmanhaemin Road	0.5 km
Tha Phae Gate	3.2 km
Chiang Mai Airport	4.1 km
Wat Phra That Doi Suthep	11 km

18–21 Jan · 2 adults, 1 room

Deluxe Lanna Room · King bed · 38 m² · 2 guests · ฿4,200 / night

Heritage Suite with Fireplace · King bed · 62 m² · 2 guests · ฿6,800 / night

Lanna Heritage Resort

Deluxe Lanna Room

King bed · 38 m² · 2 guests

In this room: High-speed Wi-Fi · Bathtub · Minibar & coffee · Private balcony · Air conditioning · In-room safe

✓ Free cancellation before Jan 15, 2027

✓ Breakfast included for 2 guests

Total price · per night · taxes included ฿4,200

Check-in: Mon, Jan 18 · Check-out: Thu, Jan 21

Flexible dates

Total price · 3 nights · 18–21 Jan ฿12,600

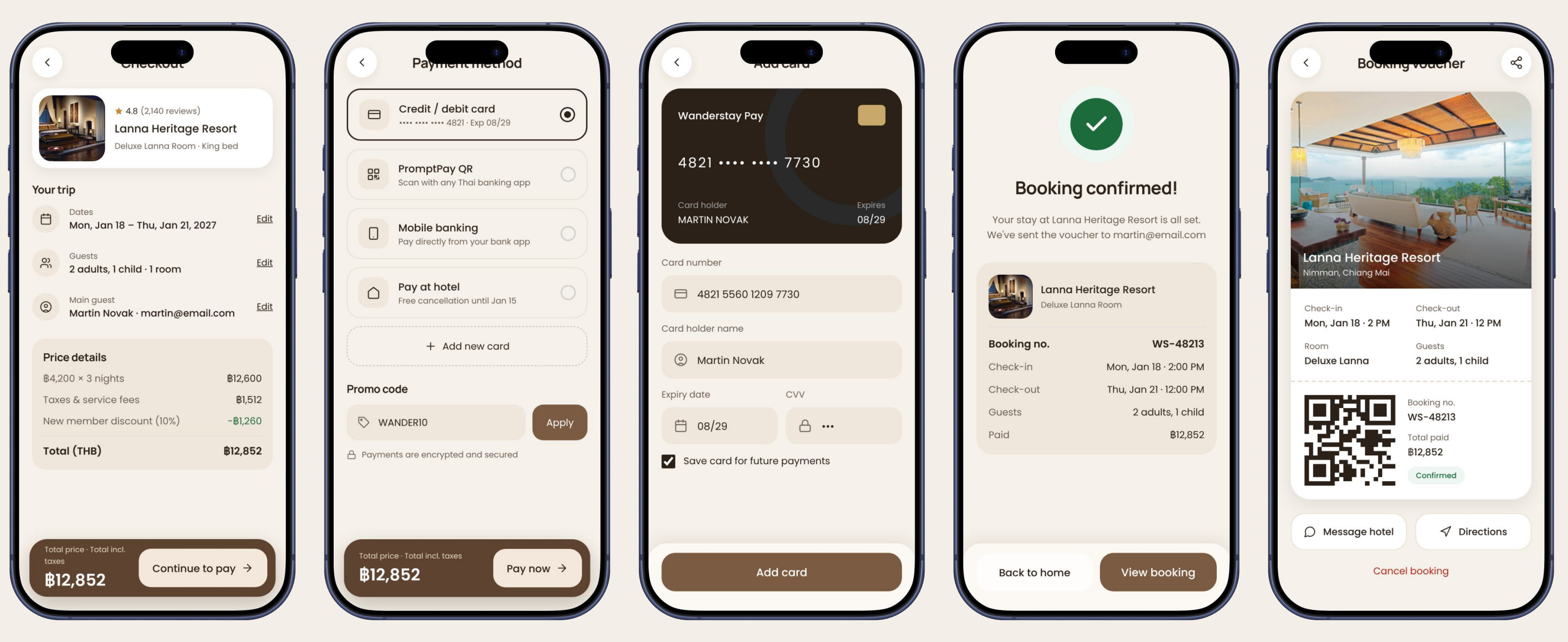
Adults	Ages 13 or above	2
Children	Ages 2–12	1
Infants	Under 2	0
Rooms	Max 4 guests per room	1

Age of child 1: 6 years old

Traveling with pets

Traveling for work

Apply · 3 guests, 1 room



★ 4.8 (2,140 reviews) Lanna Heritage Resort · Deluxe Lanna Room · King bed

Your trip

Dates: Mon, Jan 18 – Thu, Jan 21, 2027 · Edit

Guests: 2 adults, 1 child · 1 room · Edit

Main guest: Martin Novak · martin@email.com · Edit

Price details

฿4,200 × 3 nights	฿12,600
Taxes & service fees	฿1,512
New member discount (10%)	-฿1,260
Total (THB)	฿12,852

Total price · Total incl. taxes ฿12,852

Credit / debit card · •••• •••• •••• 4821 · Exp 08/29

PromptPay QR · Scan with any Thai banking app

Mobile banking · Pay directly from your bank app

Pay at hotel · Free cancellation until Jan 15

Promo code: WANDER10

Payments are encrypted and secured

Total price · Total incl. taxes ฿12,852

Wanderstay Pay · 4821 •••• •••• 7730 · Card holder MARTIN NOVAK · Expires 08/29

Card number: 4821 5560 1209 7730

Card holder name: Martin Novak

Expiry date: 08/29 · CVV: •••

☑ Save card for future payments

Booking confirmed!

Your stay at Lanna Heritage Resort is all set. We've sent the voucher to martin@email.com

Lanna Heritage Resort · Deluxe Lanna Room

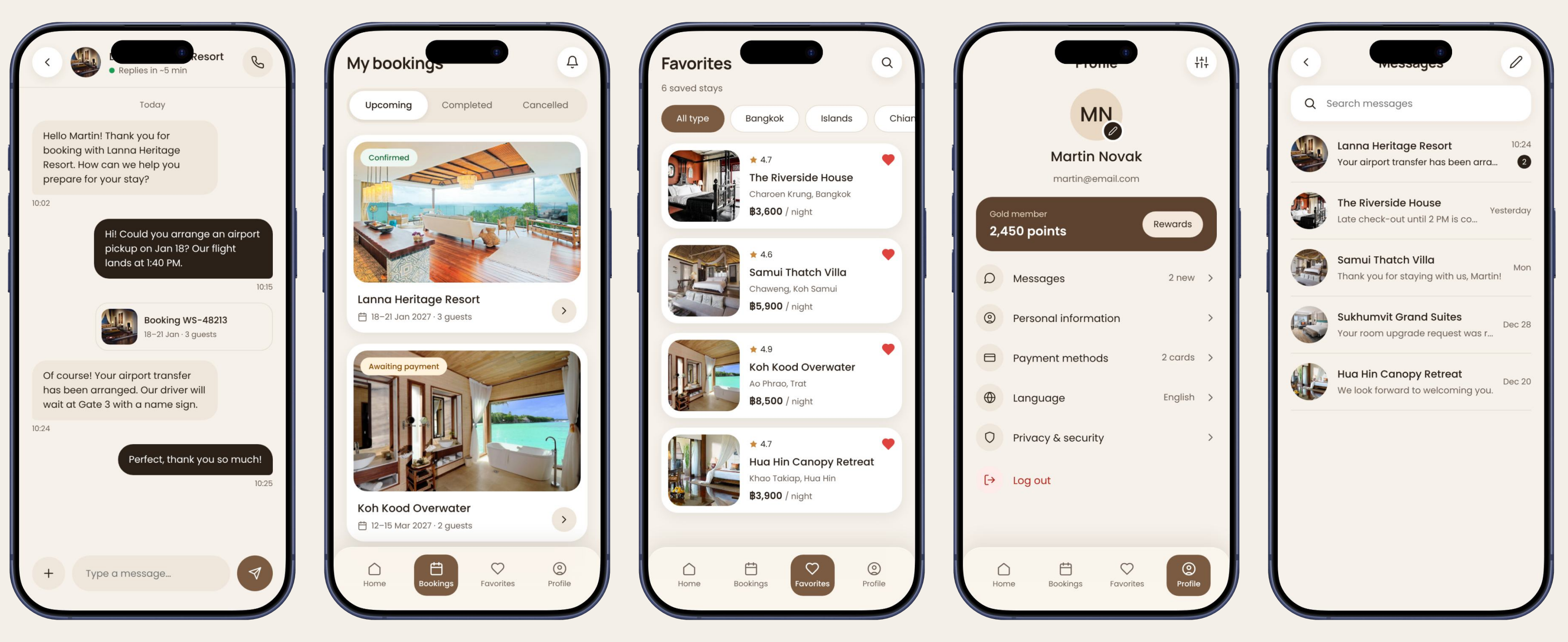
Booking no.	WS-48213
Check-in	Mon, Jan 18 · 2:00 PM
Check-out	Thu, Jan 21 · 12:00 PM
Guests	2 adults, 1 child
Paid	฿12,852

Lanna Heritage Resort · Nimman, Chiang Mai

Check-in: Mon, Jan 18 · 2 PM · Check-out: Thu, Jan 21 · 12 PM

Room: Deluxe Lanna · Guests: 2 adults, 1 child

Booking no. WS-48213 · Total paid ฿12,852



Today

Hello Martin! Thank you for booking with Lanna Heritage Resort. How can we help you prepare for your stay? — 10:02

Hi! Could you arrange an airport pickup on Jan 18? Our flight lands at 1:40 PM. — 10:15

Booking WS-48213 · 18–21 Jan · 3 guests

Of course! Your airport transfer has been arranged. Our driver will wait at Gate 3 with a name sign. — 10:24

Perfect, thank you so much! — 10:25

Lanna Heritage Resort · 18–21 Jan 2027 · 3 guests

Koh Kood Overwater · 12–15 Mar 2027 · 2 guests

6 saved stays

★ 4.7 The Riverside House · Charoen Krung, Bangkok · ฿3,600 / night

★ 4.6 Samui Thatch Villa · Chaweng, Koh Samui · ฿5,900 / night

★ 4.9 Koh Kood Overwater · Ao Phrao, Trat · ฿8,500 / night

★ 4.7 Hua Hin Canopy Retreat · Khao Takiap, Hua Hin · ฿3,900 / night

Martin Novak · martin@email.com

Gold member · 2,450 points

Messages · 2 new

Personal information

Payment methods · 2 cards

Language · English

Privacy & security

Log out

Lanna Heritage Resort	Your airport transfer has been arra…	10:24 · 2
The Riverside House	Late check-out until 2 PM is co…	Yesterday
Samui Thatch Villa	Thank you for staying with us, Martin!	Mon
Sukhumvit Grand Suites	Your room upgrade request was r…	Dec 28
Hua Hin Canopy Retreat	We look forward to welcoming you.	Dec 20